

Direct Windows Boot & Automatic Login Guide

Complete Walkthrough for Windows 10 & 11 (Automatic Sign-In, Dual-Boot & Lock Screen)

Scope & Overview: Depending on your system setup, 'going straight into Windows' means either: (1) **Bypassing the password / PIN prompt** to auto-login to the Desktop, (2) **Skipping the Dual-Boot / GRUB OS selector**, or (3) **Bypassing the lock screen wallpaper** on startup.

1. Setting Up Automatic Login (Bypass Password / PIN)

To boot straight into your Windows Desktop without stopping at the user selection or password screen:

Method A: The netplwiz Utility (Built-in Windows Method)

Step 1 (Windows 11 / Modern Win 10 only): Windows Hello must be configured to permit password autologin. Go to **Settings > Accounts > Sign-in options**. Find *'For improved security, only allow Windows Hello sign-in for Microsoft accounts'* and toggle it **OFF**.

Step 2: Press **Win + R**, type **netplwiz** (or **control userpasswords2**), and press **Enter**.

Step 3: In the User Accounts window, highlight your username.

Step 4: Uncheck the box: *'Users must enter a user name and password to use this computer'*.

Step 5: Click **Apply**. In the pop-up dialog, enter and confirm your account password, then click **OK**.

Step 6: Restart your PC. Windows will now log in automatically.

Method B: Microsoft Sysinternals Autologon (Recommended Official Utility)

If the netplwiz checkbox is missing or you use a Microsoft / Azure AD domain account, Microsoft's official Sysinternals tool provides an encrypted, reliable solution:

1. Download **Autologon** from Microsoft Learn (learn.microsoft.com/sysinternals/downloads/autologon).
2. Extract and run **AutoLogon.exe** as Administrator.
3. Enter your Username, Domain (or PC name for local accounts), and Password, then click **Enable**.
4. The credentials are encrypted into the LSA secrets registry hive. To disable later, reopen Autologon and click **Disable**.

2. Dual-Boot Systems: Booting Straight into Windows

If your computer stops at a boot menu (e.g. dual-booting Windows and Linux, or multiple Windows versions):

Scenario A: Windows Boot Manager Selection Screen

1. Press **Win + R**, type **msconfig**, and press **Enter**.
2. In the **Boot** tab, select your Windows installation and click **Set as default**.
3. Change the **Timeout** field to **0** (or **3** seconds if 0 is not supported).
4. Click **Apply** and **OK**.

Scenario B: UEFI / Motherboard BIOS Boot Priority

If the PC boots into another drive or secondary bootloader by default:

- 1. Restart your computer and press the BIOS key (**F2**, **F12**, **DeL**, or **Esc**).
- 2. Open the **Boot / Boot Priority** menu.
- 3. Move **Windows Boot Manager** to the top (#1 priority position).
- 4. Press **F10** to Save and Exit.

Scenario C: Linux GRUB Menu

If dual-booting with Linux and you want GRUB to immediately boot into Windows:

- 1. In Linux, open `/etc/default/grub` with root permissions.
- 2. Set `GRUB_DEFAULT="Windows Boot Manager (on /dev/...)"` and `GRUB_TIMEOUT=0`.
- 3. Run `sudo update-grub` and reboot.

3. Bypassing the Lock Screen Wallpaper

To jump directly to the password prompt or desktop without dismissing the lock screen wallpaper:

Group Policy (Win Pro / Enterprise): Run `gpedit.msc` → Navigate to *Computer Configuration > Administrative Templates > Control Panel > Personalization* → Enable 'Do not display the lock screen'.

Registry (Win Home): In `regedit`, go to `HKLM\SOFTWARE\Policies\Microsoft\Windows\Personalization` → Add DWORD (32-bit) `NoLockScreen` with value `1`.

4. Quick Reference Matrix & Security Trade-offs

Scenario	Primary Tool	Reversible	Security Implication
Skip Password/PIN	netplwiz / Autologon	Yes	Physical access grants full computer access.
Skip Dual-Boot Menu	msconfig / BIOS Priority	Yes	None. Alternate OS accessible via BIOS key.
Skip Lock Screen	gpedit.msc (NoLockScreen)	Yes	None. Password prompt is still shown if enabled.